

Title: Upstream Processing for Monoclonal Antibodies (mAbs)

Introduction

Upstream processing is the process of optimizing the yield, productivity, and quality for cell culture in settings such as fermenters to enhance the production of substances in the pharmaceutical industry. One of the most important compounds it is used for is antibodies. In this scenario, upstreaming refers to the production of the cells that produce the antibodies and the optimization of the conditions for their growth and productivity in the bioreactors commonly used in the industry. The upstream processing steps typically include cell line development, media optimization, and bioreactor operation. For this paper, it was desired to focus specifically this process for monoclonal antibodies (mAbs), which are used therapeutics for things such as cancer, autoimmune diseases, and other types of sicknesses.

The demand for monoclonal antibodies is constantly rising as they have become a crucial in many therapeutic and diagnostic applications. There is an urgent need to lower mAb production costs due to its importance. This makes it necessary to improve and optimize the current mAb production techniques. Several upstream procedures used in the production of mAb will be looked at in this paper. Important variables and methods will be taken into account to increase the effectiveness of these procedures. The essay will also look at how improvements in host cells, bioreactor technology, and process variables over the past ten years have helped to significantly enhance productivity, making in turn, mAb synthesis more cost effective and practical for the uses mentioned.

Section Title 1

The host cells utilized to produce monoclonal antibodies have changed throughout time and even now include a variety of cell types. Mammalian cells have traditionally more sought after as the chosen host because they have the equipment needed to fold and assemble mAbs correctly after post-translational modifications [1]. Their capacity to produce high titers of mAbs, along with their

flexibility to different growth conditions, Chinese hamster ovary (CHO) cells have emerged as the leading host cell line [2].

In recent years, efforts have been taken to alter the metabolic properties of cells, leading to improved resilience and greater, more cell specific productivity. Using metabolic engineering and synthetic biology methods, the host cell lines are optimized for greater growth, productivity, and product quality. The advancement in monoclonal antibody production as a whole has been greatly helped by the creation of these modified host cells used .

The weakness of all this, using disposable bioreactors have recently been addressed with the development of wave bioreactors for suspension cultures. These bioreactors have been used effectively to produce monoclonal antibodies on a large scale. They use a rocking motion to create waves in the culture medium. This in turn, guarantees optimal oxygen transport and mixing [4]. On the other hand, immobilized cell bioreactors, which offer a simple and affordable alternative bioreactors for lab-scale production, are another unique bioreactor technology strategy. These technologies enable high cell densities (relating to optical density which cause higher cell culture growth) and higher productivity by immobilizing cells.

Section Title 2

Enhancing the efficiency of monoclonal antibody manufacturing also requires optimizing process variables including feeding plans and environmental factors. Increased productivity and longer culture times have been made possible by the introduction of optimal feeding systems including fed-batch and perfusion cultures [3]. It is possible to support cell proliferation and keep high levels of mAb synthesis throughout the culture period by fine-tuning the feeding strategy.

A crucial component of raising monoclonal antibody production efficiency is improving process variables including feeding plans and environmental factors. Productivity has increased, and culture times have been lengthened, due to the implementation of efficient feeding systems such as fed

batch and perfusion cultures. Throughout the culture growth period, it is possible to encourage cell proliferation and keep high levels of mAb synthesis, this is done by finetuning the feeding strategy.

Conclusion

In conclusion, over the past ten years, the productivity of monoclonal antibody manufacturing has significantly increased due to improvements in upstream processes, making mAb production more practical and affordable for therapeutic applications. This development has been facilitated by the optimization of host cells, bioreactor technology, and process parameters, the creation of new bioreactor designs and the ongoing investigation into.

Some challenges that are faced regarding upstream processing of mAbs, is the optimization of cell culture conditions to ensure high productivity and product quality, while maintaining cell viability and preventing contamination. This requires a lot of work in understanding the cellular physiology of cell production. Also, looking at the use of advanced techniques such as metabolic flux analysis and omics approaches [5]. Another challenge is the scalability of the process. Upstream processing typically involves the use of large-scale bioreactors, which can be difficult to control and maintain at high cell densities [4]. This requires careful process optimization and monitoring, as well as the use of advanced control strategies such as fed batch or perfusion culture.

.... More will be added to all sections as the paper progresses, this was a basis for the final paper.

References:

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